How to mix the colour and its shades

Silver is not one colour from a tube. It is an impression of metallic shine that changes with the light and the angle of view. A silver paint with metallic particles, silver leaf and a grey with a bit of white behave differently. On a screen it can hardly be shown.

Silver cannot be mixed so that it gleams. Grey with a drop of blue and a tip of white gives a silver **shade**, not a silver **shine**. Shine comes from metallic pigments, silver leaf or from a ground that reflects light.

What to prepare



White

The basis for light silver tones.



Black

Really just a touch, for steel.



Blue

For a cool tint.



Brown

A trace for a warmer, older silver.



Grey

A ready-made neutral grey as a base.



Metallic silver paint

A ready-made paint with metallic particles for real shine.

A shade, or a shine?

Silver is the colour of light and reflection. On paper you will see how it changes when you move your head. On a screen even the best silver is only a shade.

So try silver paint for crafts on paper and look at it from several directions. **Only then decide whether a grey shade is enough for you or whether you want metal.**

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What the additions do



Blue

Shifts it to a cool, moonlike silver.





Brown

Shifts it to a warmer one, like an old piece of cutlery.





Ochre

Shifts it to champagne and light gold. Just the tip.





Violet

Shifts it to a lavender silver.





Green

Shifts it to a sage, patinated one.



White

Lightens it to pearly and misty.

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Ten silvers to try

A part can be a drop or an equally large heap of paint. The strength of pigments differs, so **take the proportions as a starting point for experimenting**. Shine is added only by metallic paint.

Basic silver



Grey and white. A shade without shine.

Steel



Grey and a trace of black and blue. Firm and cool.

Pearl



White and a tip of grey. Delicate and light.

Mirror



White, grey and a trace of blue. Clean and cold.

Oxidised



Grey, black and a trace of brown. Dark and matt.

Warm silver



Grey, white and a trace of brown. Soft and earthy.

Moon



White, blue and grey. Cool and dreamy.

Sage



Grey, white and a trace of green. Patinated.

Lavender



White, violet and grey. Delicate and airy.

Metallic



A ready-made metallic paint and a tip of black. Shine and depth.

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